RE: Question on Chemistry at Imperial

From: Gerrard, Simon R s.gerrard@imperial.ac.uk
To: Aryan Thanki aryanthanki313@hotmail.com
Cc: CHEMISTRY ADMISSIONS ch.admissions@imperial.ac.uk
Date: Mon, 4 Nov 2024, 19:59

Dear Aryan,

Thank you for getting in touch with us and for your astute question about complexity and accessibility of the course *vs* entry requirements. One contributing factor to the grades that university departments across the UK ask for is related to competition, i.e. the number of applicants to places. Another factor is reflecting the academic level and complexity of the degree programme itself.

Whilst our Chemistry degree programmes are very competitive (7.8:1, applications:places in the last cycle), the depth and breadth of academic content, the complexity (both conceptual and analytical) and level of application and problem-solving within the course from Year 1 onwards, are absolutely reflected in our high entry requirements. Our requirement for A-Level Maths (which many departments do not require for all or some of their Chemistry degrees) reflects the level of maths embedded within the course, and the application of maths required. We do structure the course to be accessible to all of our students, regardless of their educational background. However, assessments (inc. exam questions) are indeed designed to be answered/completed by high ability and high achieving students (e.g. A-A*) as you mentioned.

We shortlist applicants for interview, based on their entire UCAS application. We then use the interview to gain feedback on how students apply their knowledge, show their understanding, and problem-solve (as well as to assess motivations, engagement and their communication of Chemistry). This helps to inform our offer-making decision process.

Best wishes,

Simon

I often work late or at weekends, but do not expect a reply outside your normal working hours.

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From: Aryan Thanki <aryanthanki313@hotmail.com>
Sent: 31 October 2024 17:07
To: Gerrard, Simon R <s.gerrard@imperial.ac.uk>
Subject: Question on Chemistry at Imperial

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Hello

I have a question on whether course entry requirements for Chemistry at Imperial adequately and clearly reflect the nature of the academic course content, level of complexity of said course content, and the course examinations.

If entry requirements, are set at AAA-A*A*A, does this mean that all three elements above- the academic course content, level of complexity of said course content, and the course examinations, are designed to be accessible to the student cohort entering said course (which is why the requirements are what they are).

Does this mean that the level of a typical examination question is designed to be answerable by a high ability A-A* student, i.e in other words the average question is targeted at a high level of ability.

Many thanks and I look forward to hearing from you soon

Aryan

Sent from Outlook for iOS